

CREATING A CUSTOM NETWORK ADAPTER TO HOST AN INTERNAL NETWORK TO ENABLE YOUR VIRTUAL MACHINES COMMUNICATE ON VMWARE WORKSTATION.

This documentation provides step-by-step instructions for configuring a custom network adapter for hosting an internal network to enable your virtual machines to communicate on VMware Workstation. This setup simulates a LAN (local area network) segmentation separating specific virtual machines from being easily accessed through the internet.

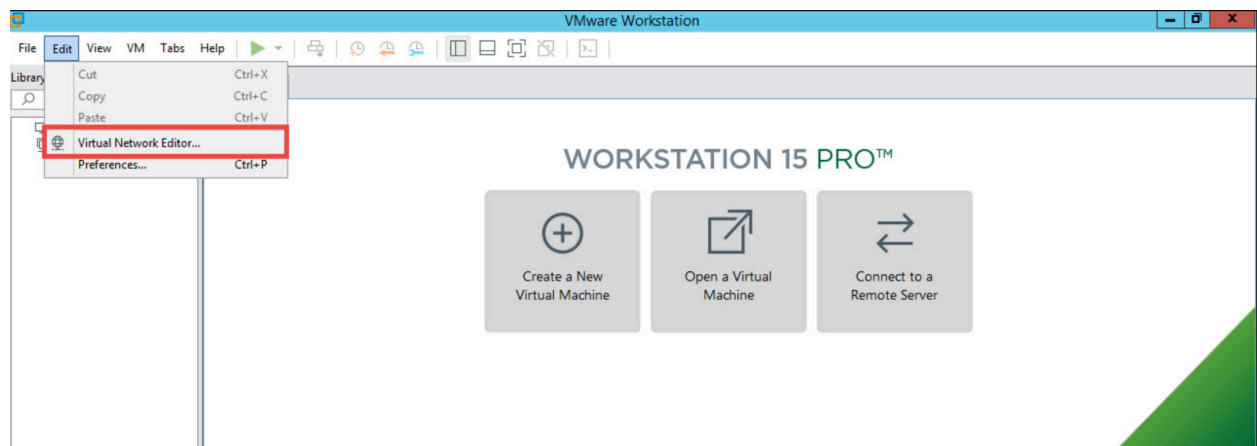
UNDERSTANDING AN INTERNAL NETWORK:

An internal network in VMware is created using a virtual switch, often a host-only or custom network type, that connects virtual machines to each other on a private network separate from the host network.

Steps to Create a custom network adapter in VMware Workstation

Step 1: Open Virtual Network Editor

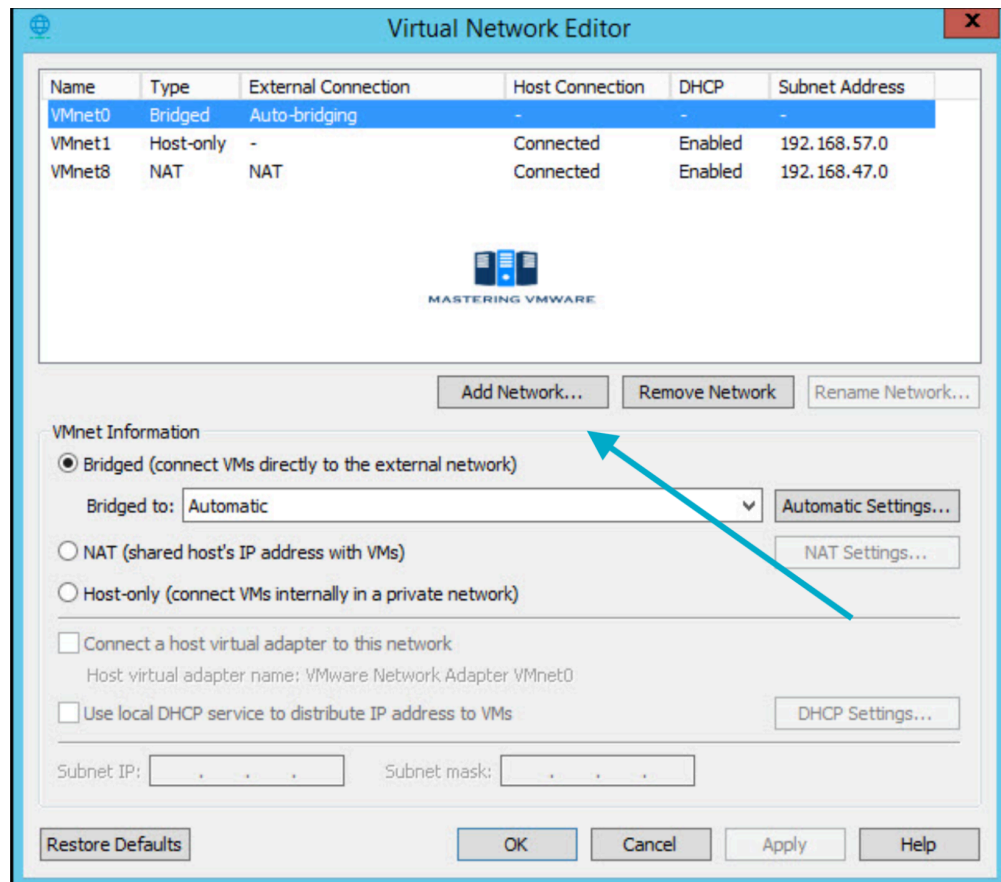
1. Launch VMware Workstation.
2. Go to the menu bar → click Edit → select Virtual Network Editor.



3. If prompted for administrator access, click Yes.

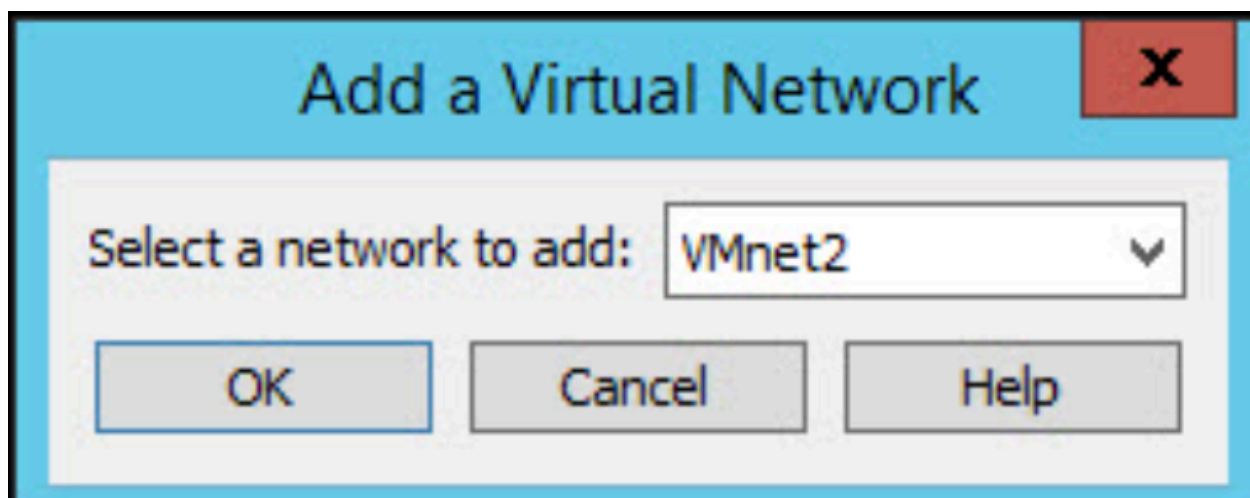
Step 2: Add a New Virtual Network

1. In the Virtual Network Editor window, click Add Network.

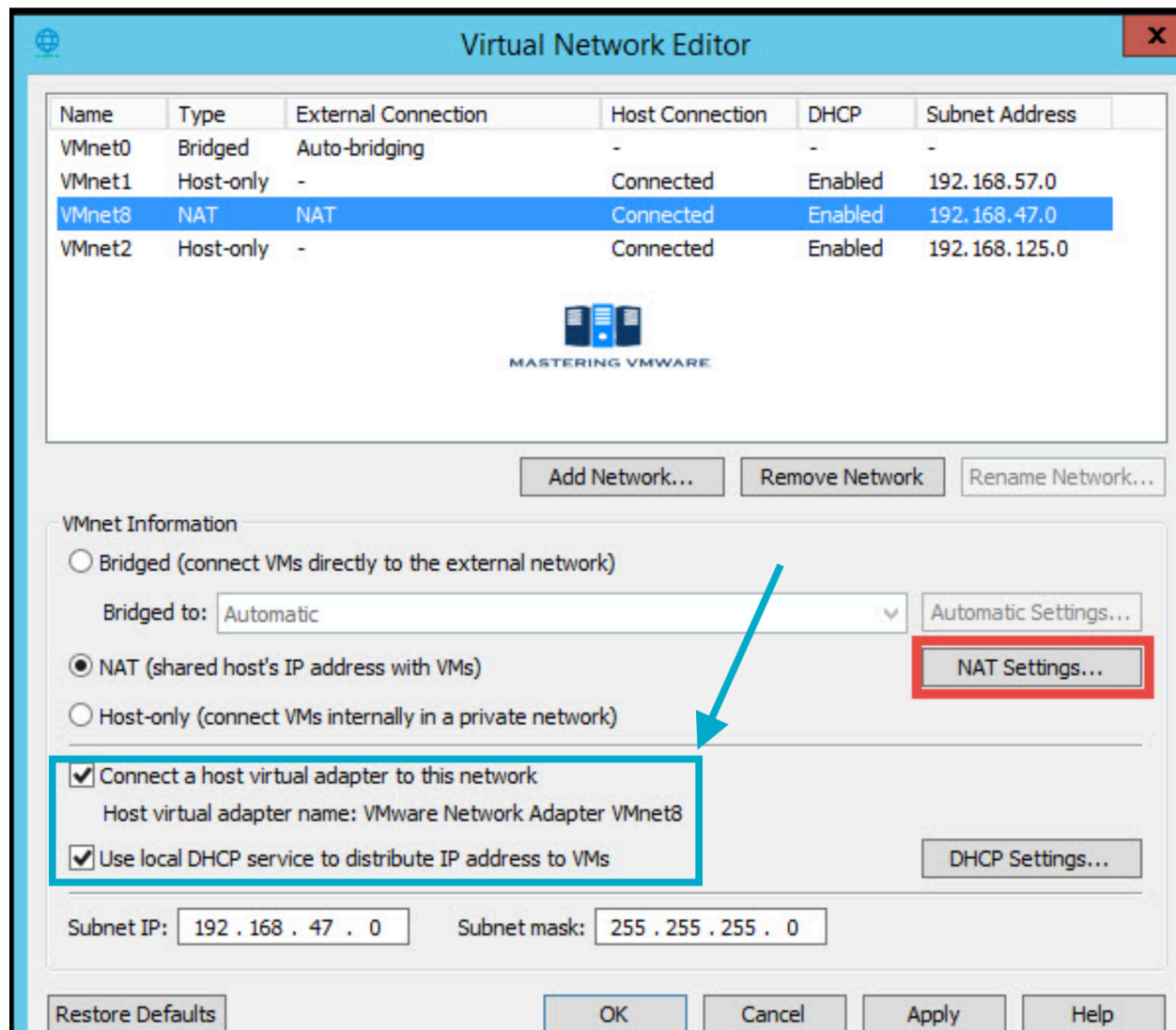


2. Select a free adapter name (e.g., VMnet8, commonly used for NAT).

3. Click OK.



Step 3: Configure the Network Type



1. In the Network Settings area, ensure “Connect a host virtual adapter to this network” is unchecked.

2. Uncheck “Use local DHCP service to distribute IP addresses” if you want to handle IP assignments manually.

3. Click OK.

Step 4: select the newly created network through the network setting of the specific VMs that you want to be on your internal network. This gives you an isolated network that can only be accessed with the use of a switch giving regulated access to and from endpoints on that network segment.